Mirto

Home video surveillance that stays in your home

Desktop app for macOS and Windows · open source · no cloud



Your cameras, someone else's computer

Your video leaves the house

Cloud cameras send what happens in your home to a server you do not control.

A fee every month, for ever

Recording, history and smart alerts sit behind a subscription.

The alternatives are for experts

Self-hosted NVRs want Docker, a server, a broker and an afternoon.



Your living room, on someone else's server

That is the trade Mirto exists to refuse.

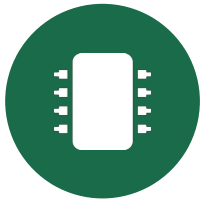
Mirto in three steps



1

It watches

Every camera the computer can reach: built-in, USB, or RTSP on the network. Unplug one and it comes back by itself.



2

It checks, on your machine

When something moves, a model on your own computer answers one question: is that a person? No frame leaves to be looked at.



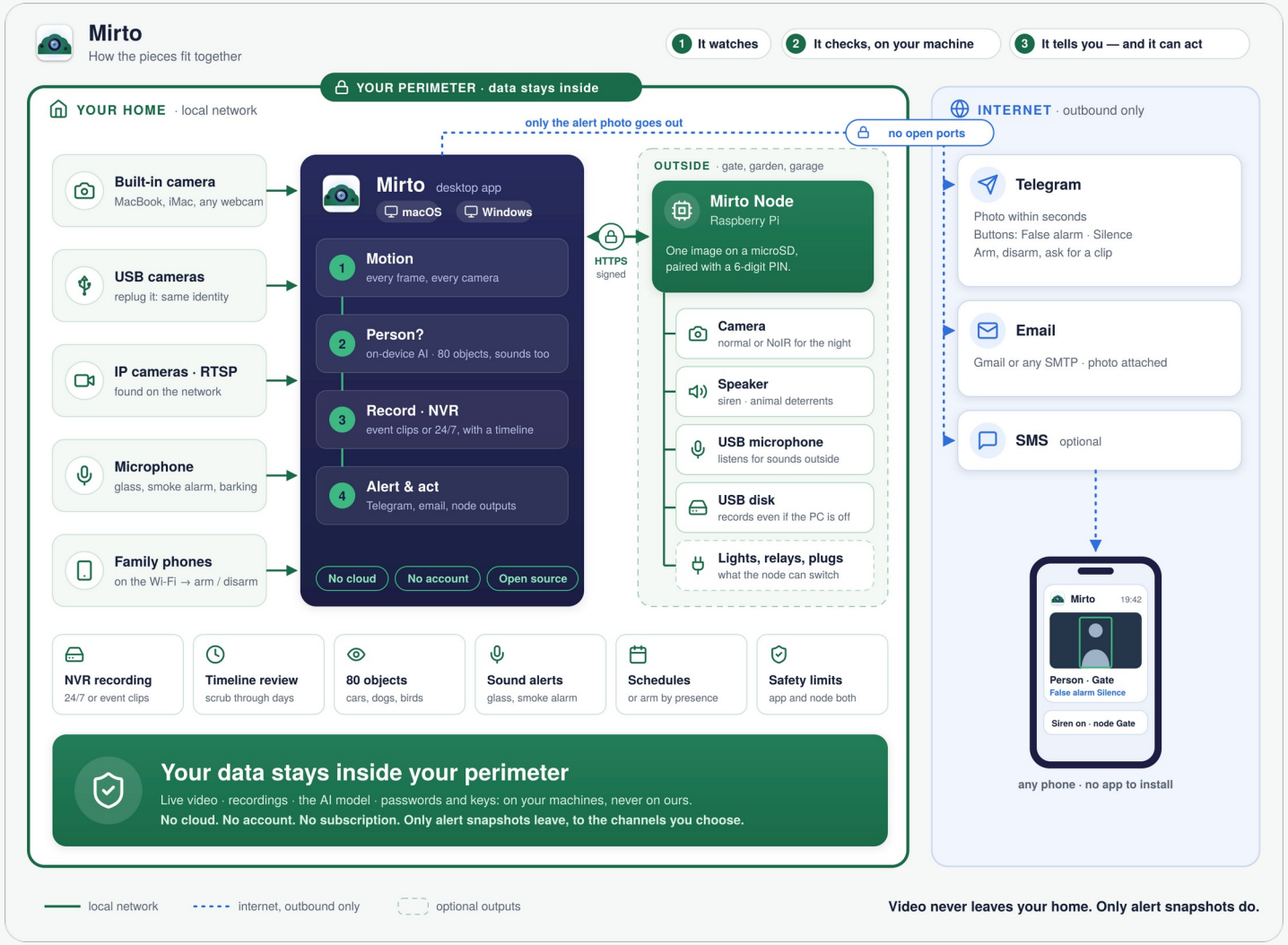
3

It tells you, and it can act

A photo on Telegram within seconds, email too. And a Raspberry Pi outside can sound a siren or switch on a light.

How the pieces fit together

Inside
Cameras, the app, the node. Everything talks on your own network.



Outside
Only the alert photo, outbound, to the channels you set up. No open ports.

Your data stays inside your perimeter

Stays inside

Live video
never streamed anywhere

Recordings
on your disk, deleted by age or quota

Detection
the AI model runs on your machine

Passwords and keys
in the system keychain, never in a file

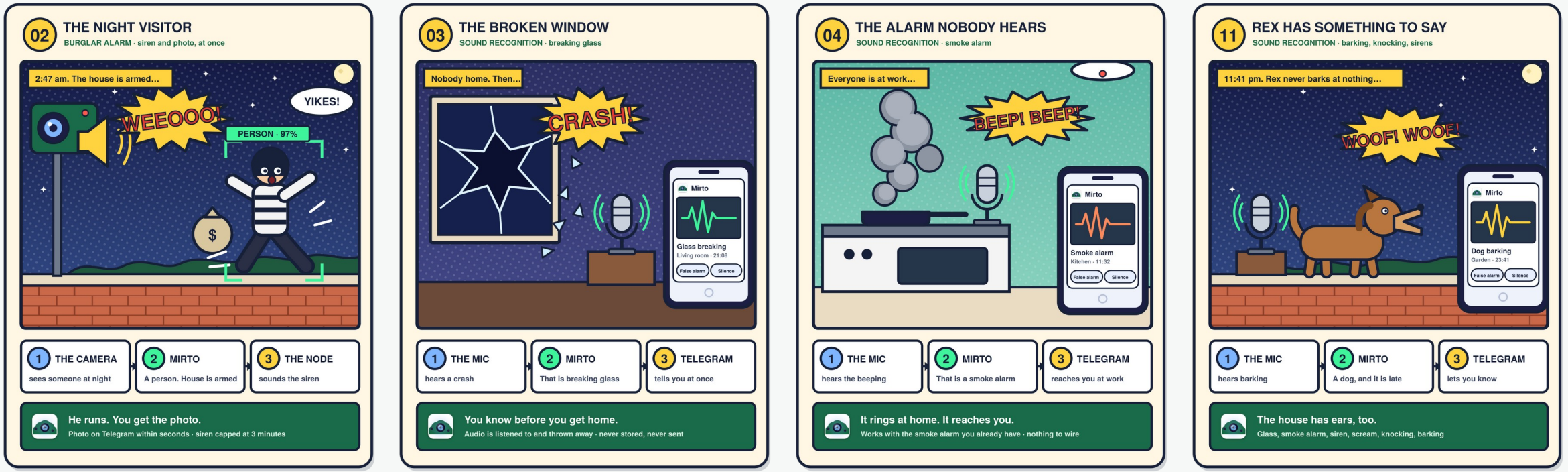
Goes out

The alert photo
to Telegram, email or SMS: only the channels you configure.

Outbound only. No open ports. No account on anything of ours.

Also: the model is downloaded once, the first time it is needed. Usage statistics exist and stay off until you say yes.

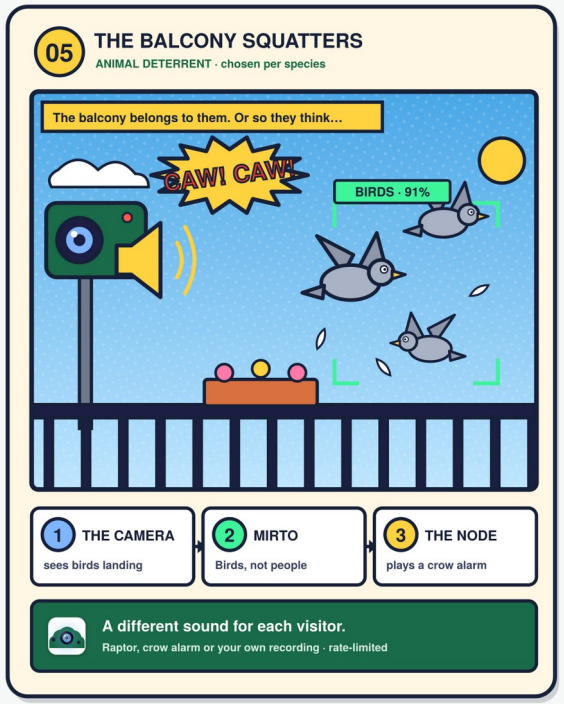
Something is wrong: you know in seconds



Burglar, broken glass, smoke alarm, barking: camera or microphone notices, Mirto recognises, Telegram tells you.

Everyday life, handled



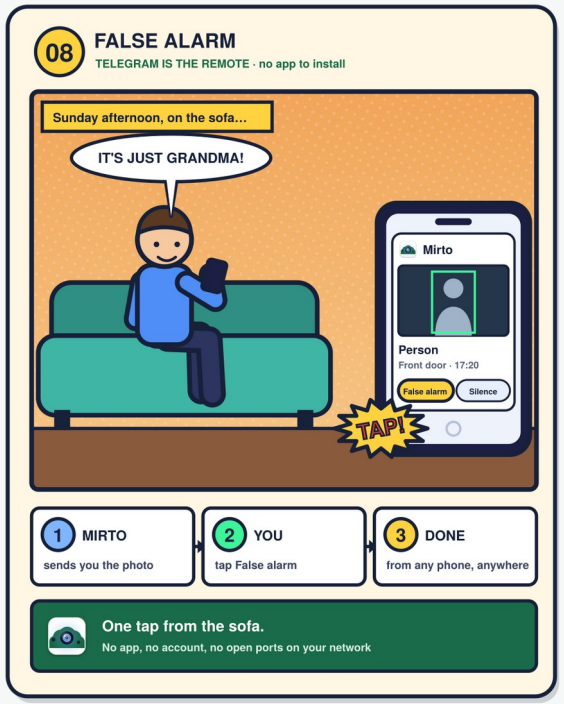






Deterrents for animals, objects beyond people, and a house that arms itself when everyone leaves.

You stay in control









Telegram is the remote, the NVR is yours, the node keeps recording, and nothing leaves the perimeter.

The node: a camera, a siren and ears, outside

1. **Write one image to a microSD**

   Every copy makes its own identity the first time it boots.

2. **Put it in a Raspberry Pi**

   Power it up near the gate, the garden, the garage.

3. **Pair it with a 6-digit PIN**

   No terminal, no key to copy. About ten minutes in all.

Mirto Node

Raspberry Pi · obeys only the computer it is paired with

- **Camera** — normal or NoIR for the night
- **Speaker** — siren and animal deterrents
- **USB microphone** — listens for sounds outside
- **USB disk** — records even if the PC is off

A real NVR, and detection that runs at home

Record

- Clips around each event: 10 s before, 20 s after
- Or continuous, 24/7
- Old footage deletes itself by age or disk quota

Review

- A timeline to scrub through
- Events marked where they happened
- Clips to Telegram on request

Recognise

- A person, or 80 other things: a car, a dog, a bird
- Sounds: glass, smoke alarm, siren, barking
- On the Mac's Neural Engine or the Windows GPU

Security by design, not by promise

Signed and pinned

Every request to a node is signed (HMAC-SHA256) with replay protection, over TLS with a pinned certificate.

Keychain, not files

Bot token, camera passwords and node keys live in the system keychain or Credential Manager. Never in a file.

Limits enforced twice

Siren: 3 minutes at most, 3 in any 30. Written in the app and again in the node, which does not trust the app.

No open ports on your network: Telegram is reached outbound, by long polling.

How it compares

	Mirto	Frigate	Fregata	SecuritySpy	Blue Iris	Scrypted
What it is	**desktop app**	Docker container	macOS port of Frigate	Mac NVR	Windows NVR	self-hosted hub
Runs on	**macOS, Windows**	Linux, Docker	Apple Silicon only	Mac only	Windows only	Docker
Price	**free, no paid tier**	free; Frigate+ $50/yr	$10 once	£35.90 to £739	$39.95 to $99.95	paid NVR plan
Open source	**all of it**	yes	core yes, port no	no	no	core only
Sirens and lights	**built in, with a node**	through MQTT	no	no	through plugins	through the hub
Ready-made outdoor node	**yes**	no	no	no	no	no
Faces, plates	**no, by choice**	yes	via Frigate+	faces	plugins	plugins

Where they win: deeper detection, Home Assistant integration, phone apps, more cameras on one machine.

Prices and claims from each vendor's own pages, checked between 18 October and 9 November 2026.

Open source, and where it is going





Apache 2.0

- No paid tier, no open-core
- No cloud to sell you
- No CLA: signed-off commits
- Funded by sponsors, not by your data

Now

First release, 0.2.0

Downloads for macOS and Windows, not signed yet

Windows tested on a real PC

Next

Signed downloads: the first thing funding buys

Home Assistant and MQTT

Windows parity

More cameras, more languages

Never

Video in a cloud

A closed Pro version

Faces or licence plates

Next steps: what the others have, open source

Direction

MQTT devices

Plugs, relays and sensors that speak MQTT, driven from Mirto without a cloud in the middle.

On the roadmap

Home Assistant

Events and armed state published locally, so Mirto fits the setups people already have.

Try it. Read it. Break it.

github.com/marcopogo81/mirto
Download, source, guide and roadmap